

Do minor league giveaways create attendance, or just move it? Triple-A baseball, 2026 · 1,889 home dates · 312 verified giveaways · 30 clubs			
Giveaway lift	Extra fans per giveaway	Giveaways analysed	Clubs with complete promo data
4.6	243	198	17

Giveaways add roughly 5% to a Triple-A crowd — a few hundred fans on a gate of 6,000, far below how promotions are usually described.

The project set out to separate that lift from demand merely pulled forward from adjacent games. One season cannot answer that: giveaways cluster on Saturdays and homestands run Tuesday to Sunday, so "the day before a giveaway" is largely a synonym for "Friday". The apparent displacement effect does not survive homestand fixed effects. See Robustness.

league, club

^ ☐ International League

- ☐ Buffalo Bisons
- ☐ Charlotte Knights
- ☐ Columbus Clippers
- ☐ Durham Bulls
- ☐ Gwinnett Stripers
- ☐ Indianapolis Indians
- ☐ Iowa Cubs
- ☐ Jacksonville Jumbo Shrimp
- ☐ Lehigh Valley IronPigs
- ☐ Louisville Bats
- ☐ Memphis Redbirds
- ☐ Nashville Sounds
- ☐ Norfolk Tides
- ☐ Omaha Storm Chasers
- ☐ Rochester Red Wings
- ☐ Scranton/Wilkes-Barre RailRiders
- ☐ St. Paul Saints
- ☐ Syracuse Mets
- ☐ Toledo Mud Hens
- ☐ Worcester Red Sox

^ ☐ Pacific Coast League

☐ Albuquerque Isotopes

☐ El Paso Chihuahuas

☐ Las Vegas Aviators

☐ Oklahoma City Comets

☐ Reno Aces

☐ Round Rock Express

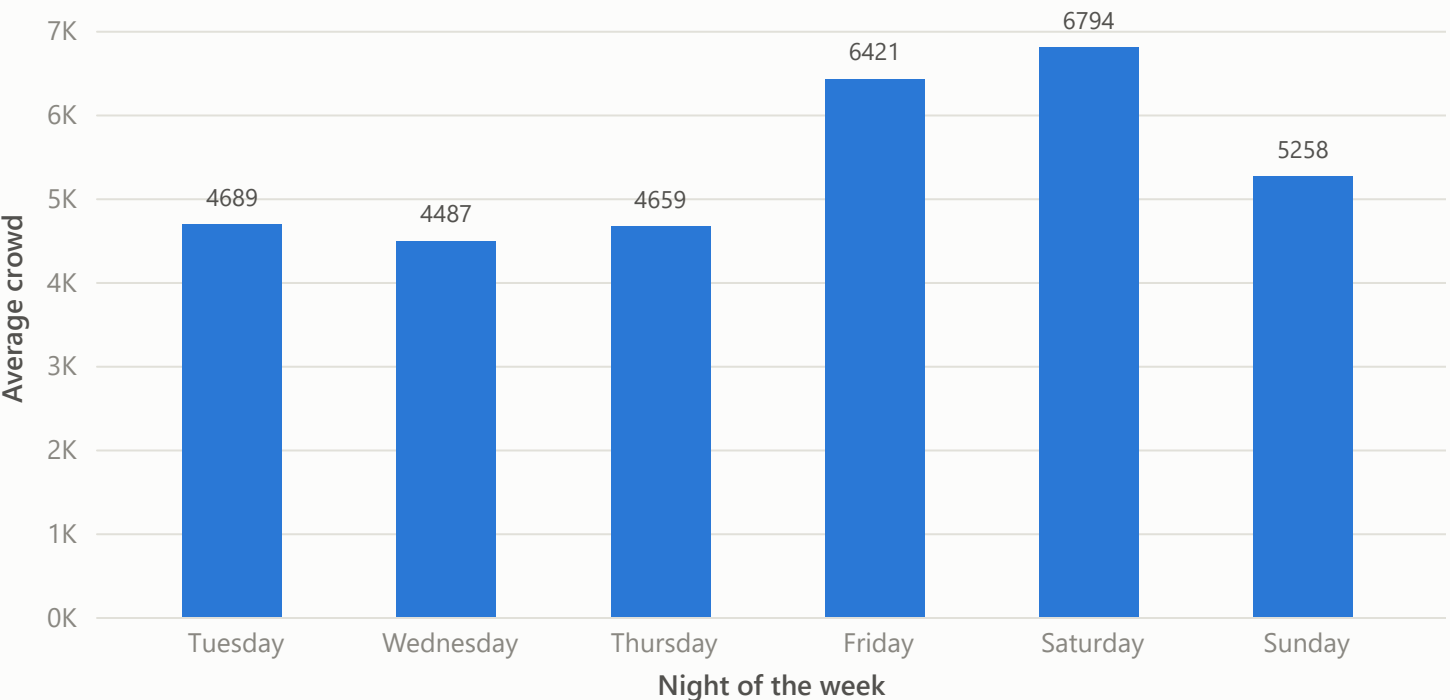
☐ Sacramento River Cats

What drives attendance before any promotion

Triple-A baseball, 2026 season · 1,889 home dates across 30 clubs

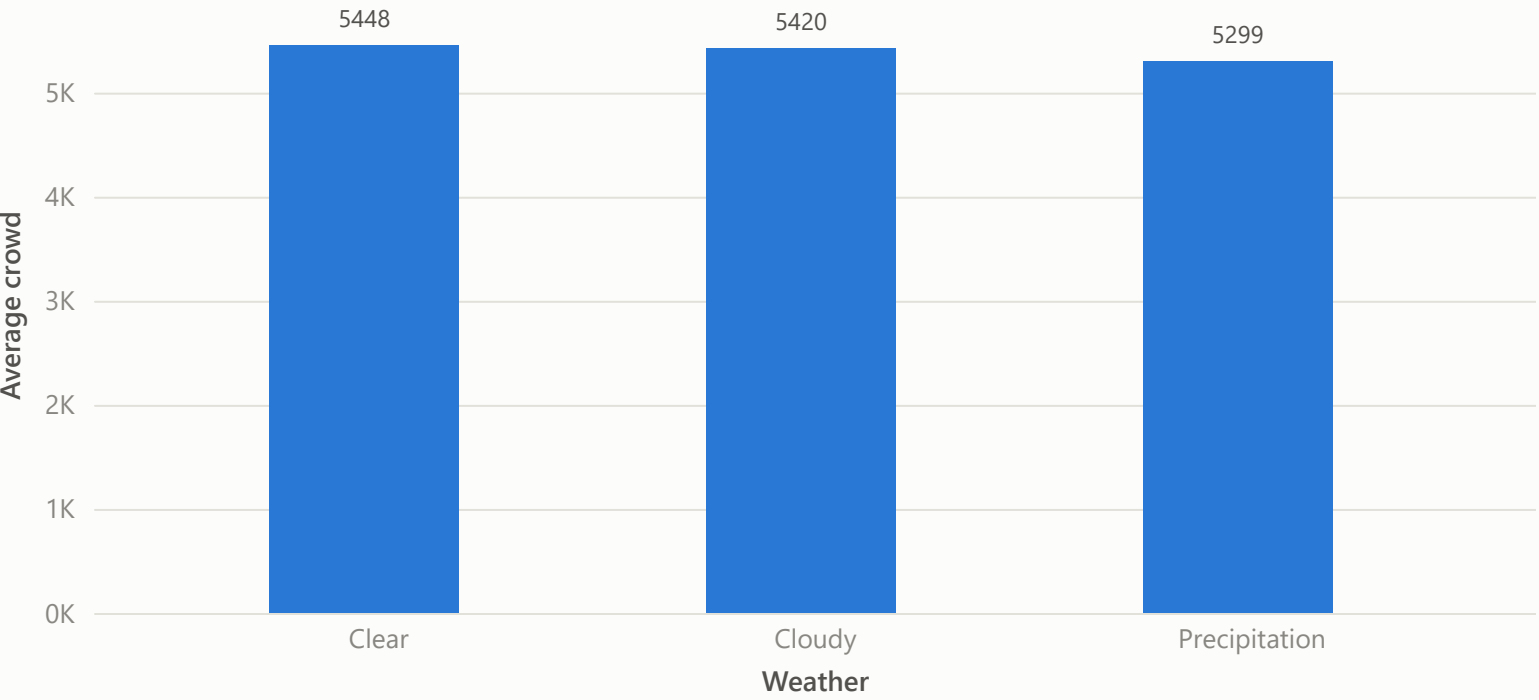
Weekend crowds run a third larger than midweek

Tuesday to Sunday · Monday excluded (3 dates, all Memorial Day)



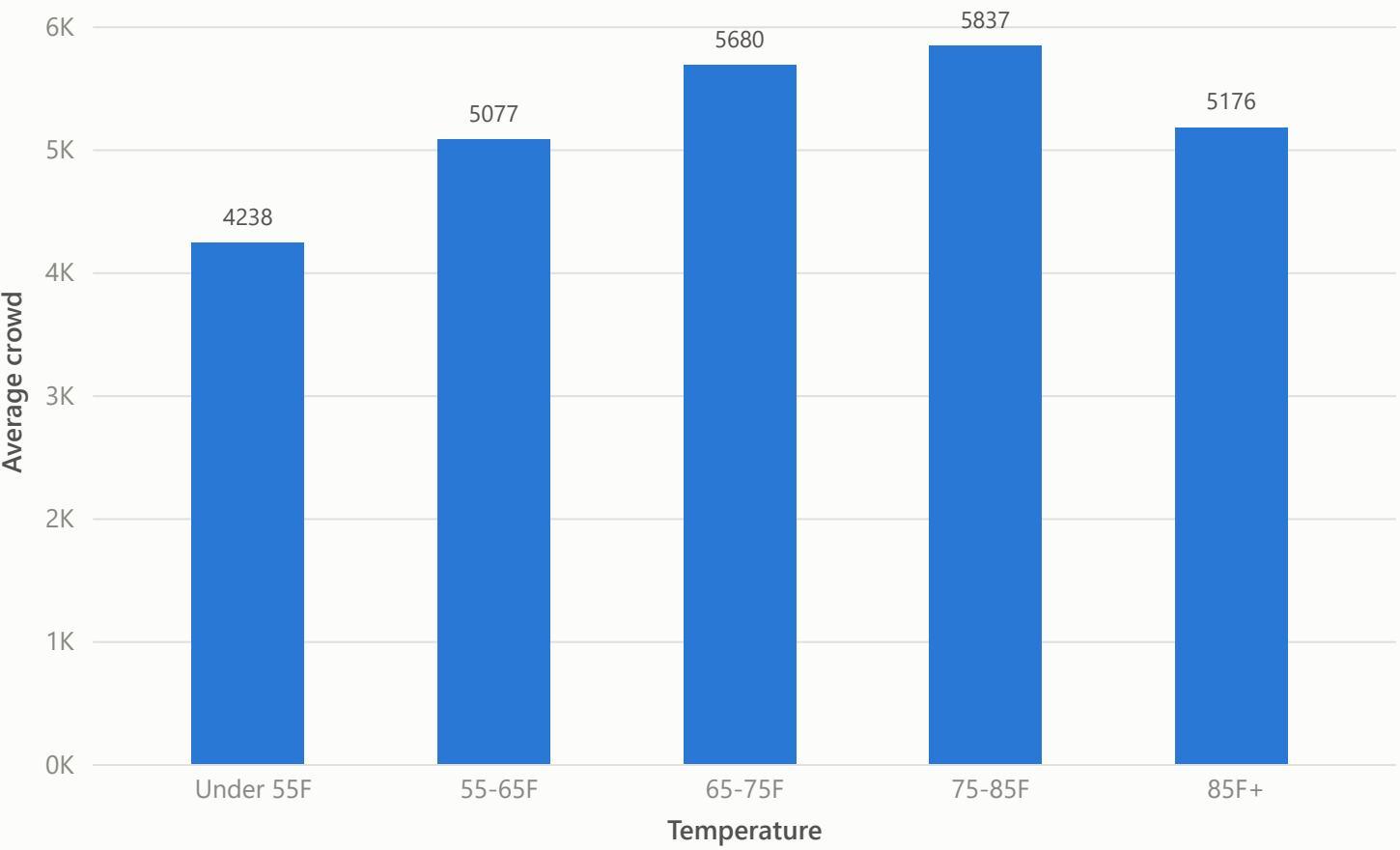
Weather barely moves attendance

Mean crowd by sky conditions at first pitch



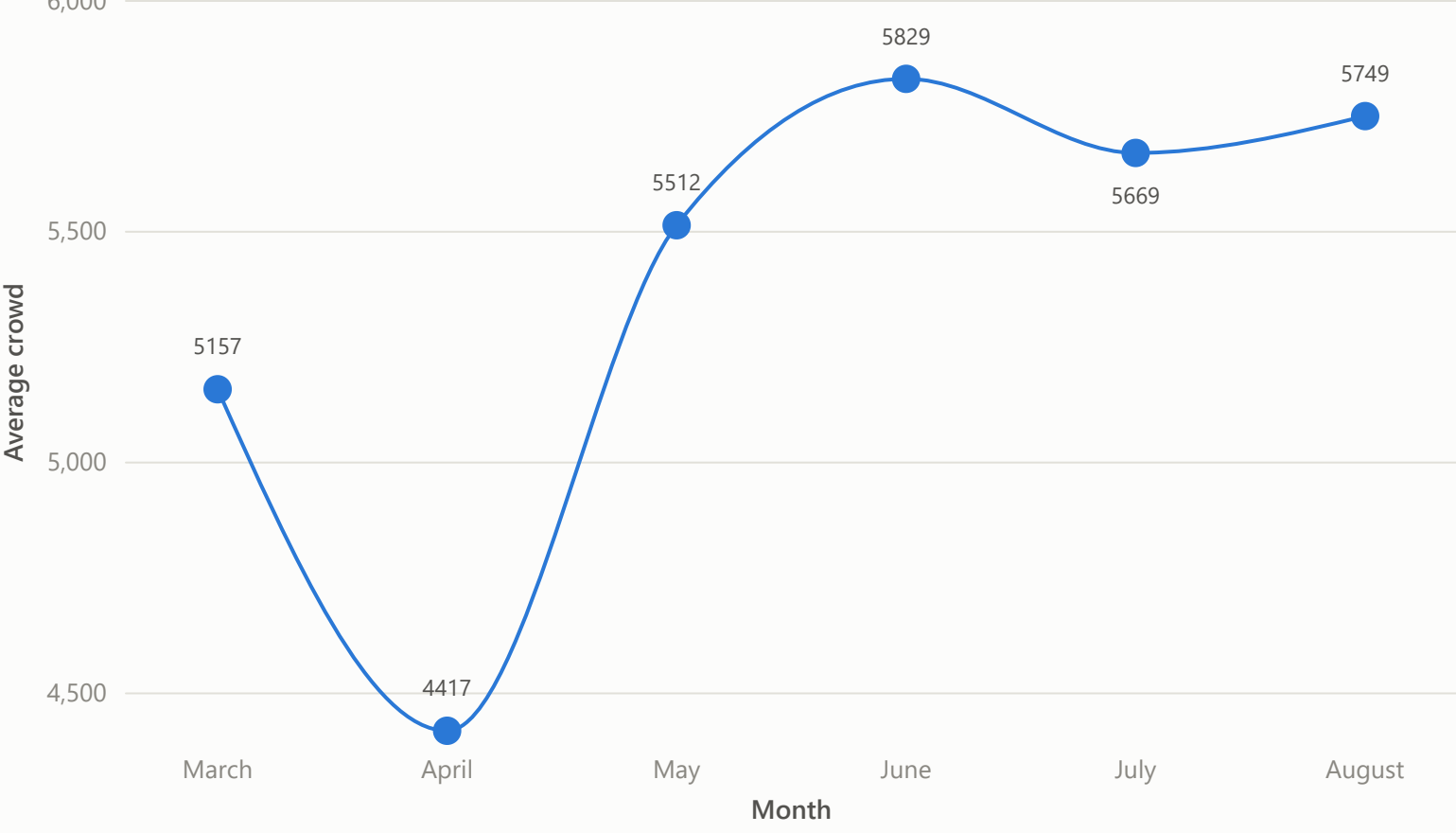
Attendance peaks at 75-85°F and falls off in the heat

Mean crowd by temperature recorded at the ballpark at first pitch



Attendance across the season

Mean crowd by month



Do giveaways actually add anyone?

198 giveaways across the 17 clubs with complete promotional calendars

Giveaways analysed

198

Lift on giveaway dates

4.6

Giveaway dates draw 4.6% above their own expectation

Actual crowd versus what the model expected, given club, night, month and weather

Effect vs Expected %

4.6

-0.9

Giveaway

No giveaway

Extra fans each

243

Baseline Crowd

6.07K

Effect by night — and where it cannot be trusted

Night	Dates	Effect %	CI low	CI high	Note
Tuesday	11	15.75	-4.50	40.29	
Wednesday	24	-3.71	-12.22	5.63	
Thursday	14	-14.50	-21.21	-7.22	
Friday	46	4.84	-4.98	15.67	
Saturday	79	9.91	3.79	16.38	Control pool smaller than treated group - not validated
Sunday	23	1.01	-11.05	14.71	

The findings

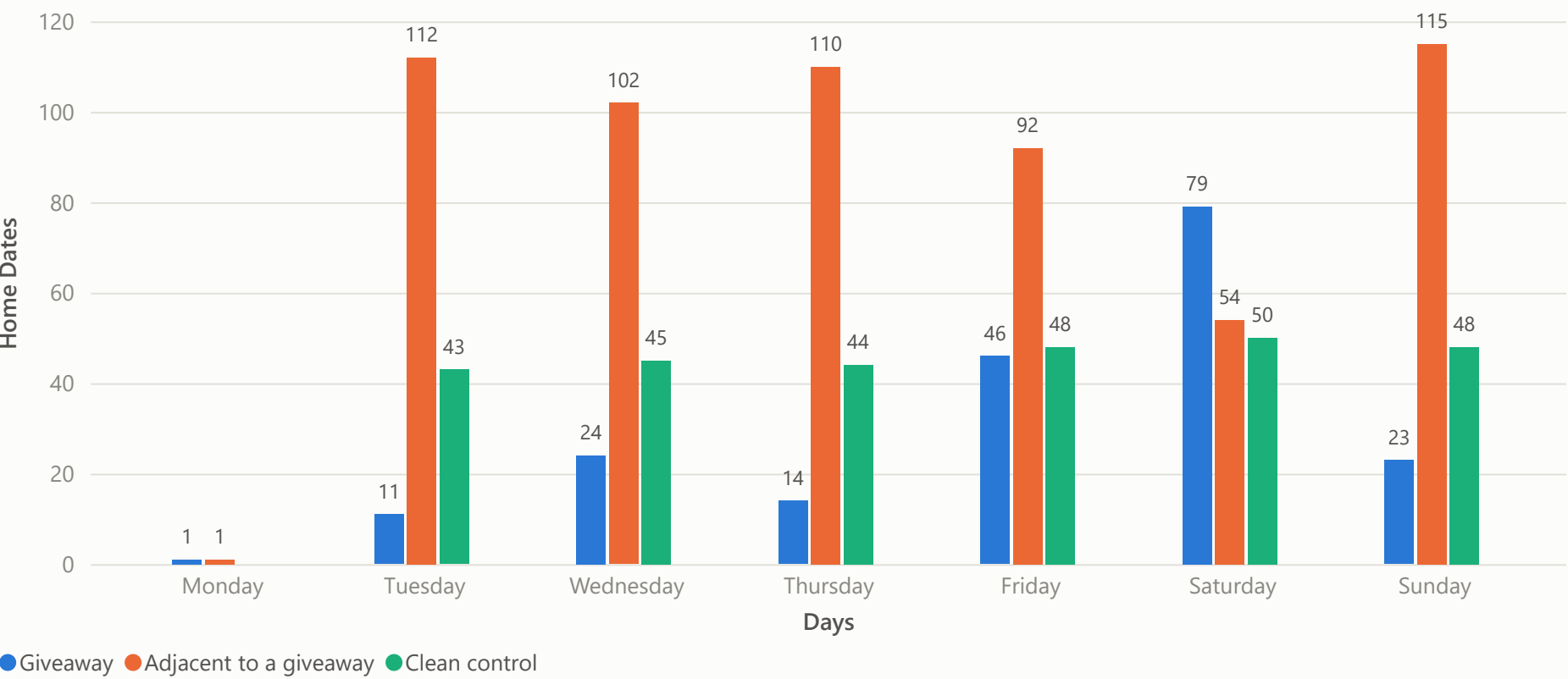
- Giveaways add roughly 5% to a Triple-A crowd — about 240 fans on a gate of 6,000. Far below how promotions are usually described.
- The estimate survives a placebo test: 400 fake giveaway sets matched on weekday produce a mean effect of −0.9%, against an observed +4.6%.
- Saturday shows the largest effect and is the one night that cannot be validated — 79 of 129 eligible Saturdays carried a giveaway, so the control group is smaller than the treated group.

Robustness: what survived and what didn't

The same estimate under two defensible samples, and why the displacement result was dropped

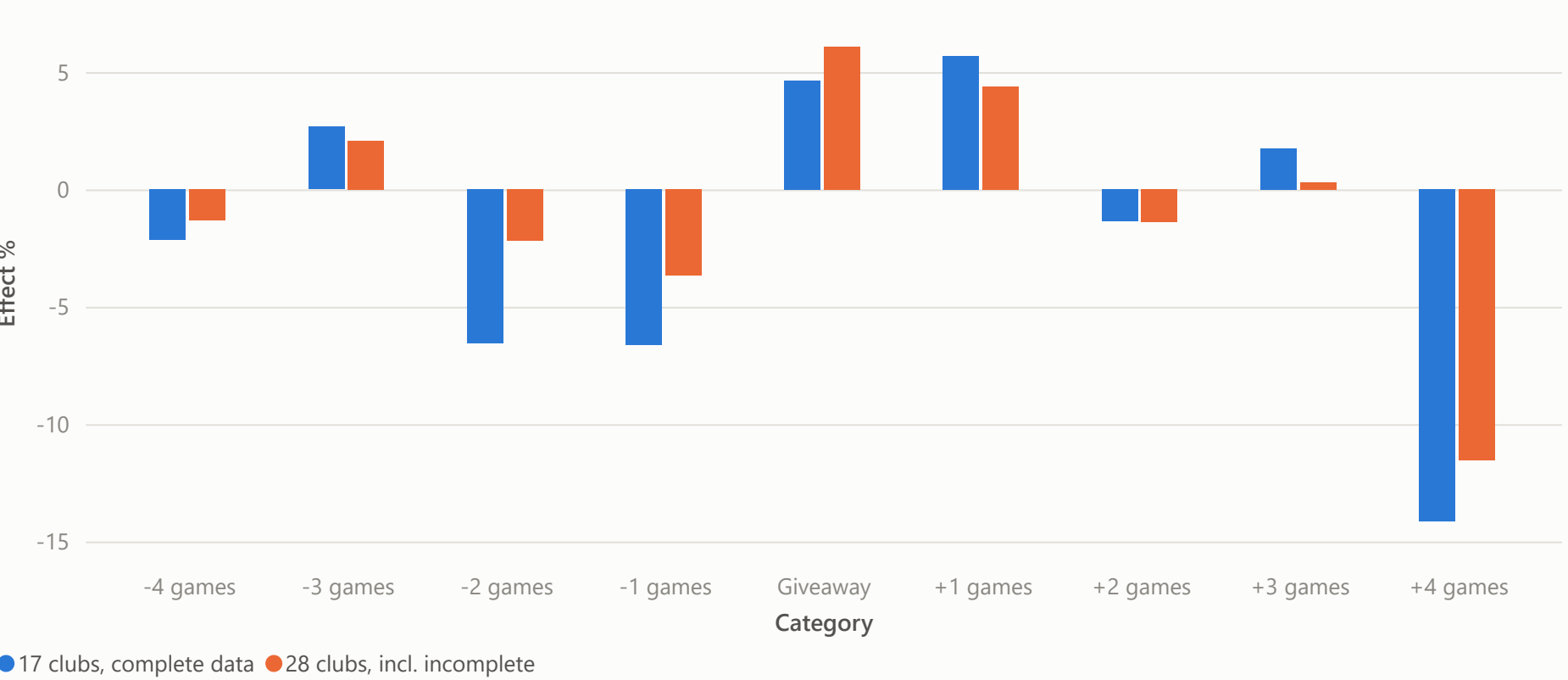
On Saturdays the control group is smaller than the treated group

Eligible home dates by night, split by whether a giveaway ran



The day-before dip clears zero in one sample and not the other

Effect on attendance by position in the homestand, estimated on two club samples



Estimates with 95% intervals — shaded rows clear zero

Same model on 17 complete-coverage clubs and on all 28 clubs

Category	Sample	Effect %	CI Low	CI High	Result n	
Giveaway	28 clubs, incl. incomplete	6.08		2.26	10.04	261
Giveaway	17 clubs, complete data	4.63		0.49	8.94	198
+1 games	28 clubs, incl. incomplete	4.40		-1.24	10.37	171
-1 games	28 clubs, incl. incomplete	-3.66		-7.68	0.54	170
+1 games	17 clubs, complete data	5.68		-0.62	12.38	140
-1 games	17 clubs, complete data	-6.63		-11.16	-1.86	129
-2 games	28 clubs, incl. incomplete	-2.18		-8.15	4.18	126
-3 games	28 clubs, incl. incomplete	2.06		-4.60	9.18	102
-2 games	17 clubs, complete data	-6.56		-12.98	0.34	88
-3 games	17 clubs, complete data	2.67		-5.14	11.12	72
+2 aames	28 clubs. incl. incomplete	-1.40		-8.69	6.47	61

- The giveaway effect holds at +4.6% on the 17 clubs with complete promotional calendars, and +6.1% across all 28.
- Intervals that cross zero are indistinguishable from no effect.
- The –14.2% at +4 games rests on 14 dates and should not be read as a finding.

Clubs, and which ones the analysis can use

30 clubs · 17 with complete promotional data · headline results use those 17 only

Clubs in the league-season

30

With complete promo data

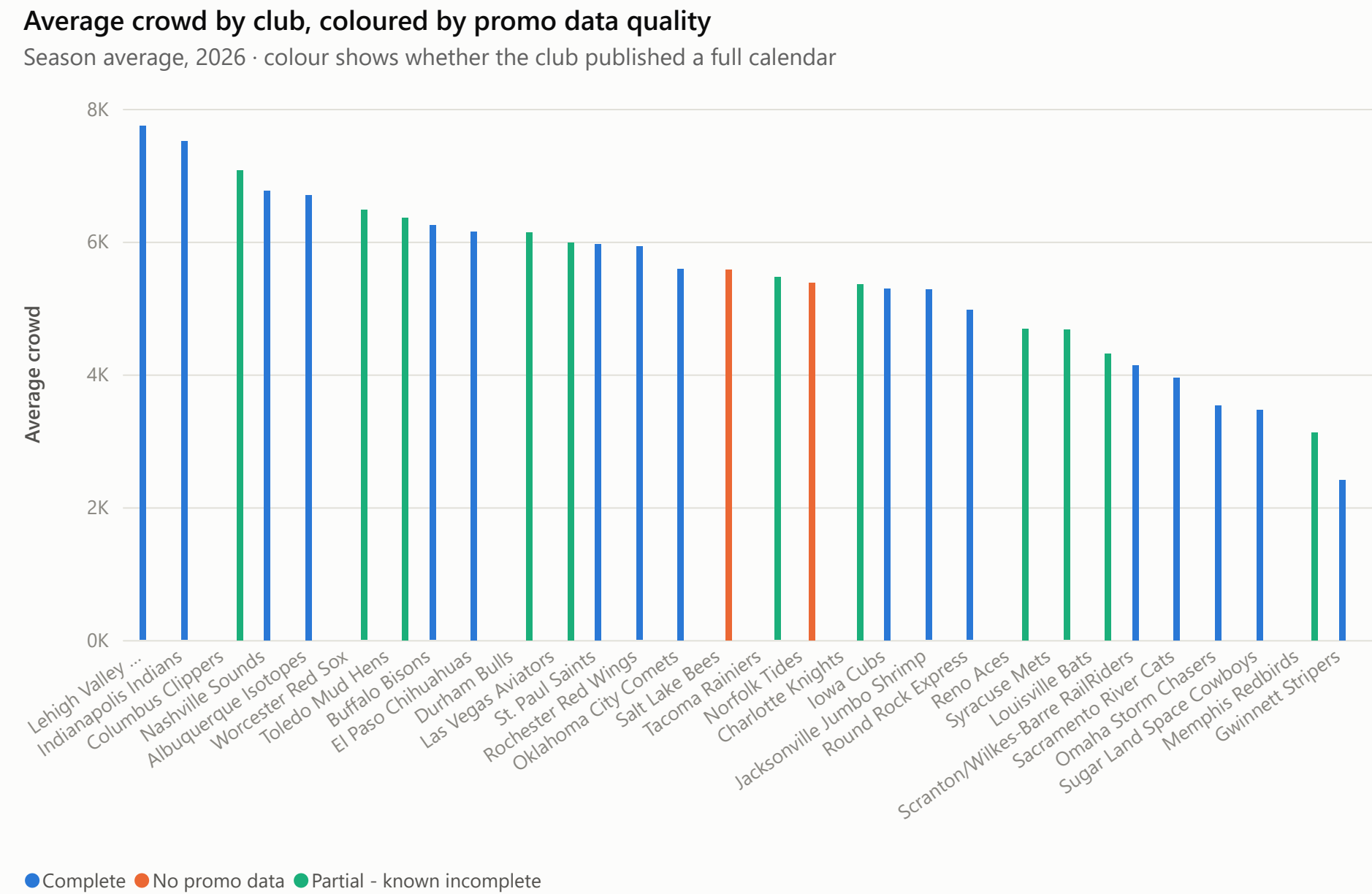
17

Gap, biggest to smallest club (×)

3.21

Average crowd range

2,409 – 7,740



Club detail						
Club	League	Home Dates	Avg Crowd	Giveaways	Share of dates	Promo Data
Buffalo Bisons	International League	58	6,245.00	8	13.79%	Complete
Charlotte Knights	International League	66	5,362.00	10	15.15%	Partial - known incomplete
Columbus Clippers	International League	58	7,074.00	2	3.45%	Partial - known incomplete
Durham Bulls	International League	67	6,142.00	1	1.49%	Partial - known incomplete
Gwinnett Stripers	International League	59	2,409.00	9	15.25%	Complete
Indianapolis Indians	International League	67	7,510.00	10	14.93%	Complete
Iowa Cubs	International League	64	5,292.00	2	3.13%	Complete
Jacksonville Jumbo Shrimp	International League	66	5,277.00	15	22.73%	Complete
Lehigh Valley IronPigs	International League	65	7,740.00	26	40.00%	Complete
Louisville Bats	International League	65	4,314.00	2	3.08%	Partial - known incomplete
Memphis Redbirds	International League	61	3,131.00	12	19.67%	Partial - known incomplete
Nashville Sounds	International League	60	6,767.00	24	40.00%	Complete
Norfolk Tides	International League	56	5,381.00	0	0.00%	No promo data
Omaha Storm Chasers	International League	62	3,537.00	7	11.29%	Complete

League

☐ International League

☐ Pacific Coast League

Promotional calendar

☐ Complete

☐ No promo data

☐ Partial - known incomplete

- Average crowds range from 2,409 (Gwinnett) to 7,740 (Lehigh Valley) — a 3.2x spread. Club identity is the single largest driver of attendance, which is why the model carries club fixed effects before any promotion is considered.
- Giveaway counts are not comparable across clubs: 17 published a full season calendar, 11 did not and their totals are undercounts, and 2 published nothing dated. Headline results use the 17 only.